GeoNews — Week 44/2026

Weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African Rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 26 October 2026

> **What is GeoNews?** An **automatically compiled weekly digest**. A research workflow scans publications from the past one to two weeks as well as funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria and assembles this issue from them.
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> The thematic profile follows **the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human–environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and nonlinear time-series analysis. Researchers in these fields will probably find something useful here — it is explicitly not a complete overview of Quaternary science.
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> Selection, scoring and summaries are machine-generated and reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; when in doubt, the linked original source prevails.

Each paper receives a score of 0–100 from five criteria: topical fit (40), methodological fit (25), impact/venue (15), connectivity (10) and recency (10). Categories: 🔴 75 and above must-read · 🟡 50–74 relevant · 🟢 30–49 radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and prioritises reading — it is not a quality judgement on the individual paper.

In brief

Around forty papers assessed, this week **six 🔴 must-reads**, all abstract-based. A primary hit directly from the East African Rift is again missing; instead the focus is on **monsoon and human–environment coupling on orbital timescales** and on **lake water balance and palaeoflood calibration**.

At the top: a **500-kyr dust record from the western equatorial Indian Ocean** (*Nature Communications*) which, according to the abstract, links hominin population expansions in Arabia not only to "Green Arabia" humid phases but also to brief high-intensity rainfall phases within glacials; and a **450-kyr speleothem record of the South American Summer Monsoon** (*Nature*) that mostly runs out of phase with the Asian monsoon but exceeds a synchronicity threshold in ten events. The other 🔴: a **dual-isotope water balance (P−E) for Lake Junín** since the LGM, **439 kyr of crater-lake sediments from Rodderberg** (East Eifel), a **process check of flood turbidites against monitoring data in Lake Lucerne**, and **ten lake cores from the Kasaï Basin** (Congo) suggesting that the Late Holocene rainforest crisis was more widespread than assumed.

In the 🟡 block: **White Sands** (humans and the abrupt desiccation of a pluvial lake during the LGM), a **re-dated Early Weichselian sequence in Lower Saxony** (Oerel/Glinde → MIS 5a/4), a **perspective paper on process-informed early warning systems** and a **PNAS approach to tipping-point forecasting with neural operators**.

Funding: **ICDP AGU travel grants (8 Nov)**, opening of the **Horizon Europe palaeoclimate call (17 Nov)**, **ERC Consolidator (12 Jan 2027)**, **ICDP proposals (15 Jan 2027)**. Policy: Germany's Bundestag research committee was scheduled on 14 Oct to decide on a **public hearing on the WissZeitVG reform** (no date published at the time of writing); the **budget committee's final session on the 2027 federal budget** is on **12 Nov**, the final vote on **27 Nov**; the **European Parliament** adopted its position on the 2027 EU budget on 21 Oct (reportedly +€63 million for Horizon Europe).

Part A — Papers of the week

Covered are papers with a Crossref `created` date from 12 October 2026 onwards that were not listed in a previous issue. For every entry with an accessible abstract (OpenAlex, Crossref or publisher page), the assessment is based on that abstract; titles without an available abstract are marked ⚠ *title-based*.

Must-read (75 and above)

1. Arabian hydroclimate and hominin population dynamics over the last 500,000 years · *Nature Communications*, 2026 · **Score 83** A multi-proxy, high-resolution **dust record from the western equatorial Indian Ocean** spanning the last 500 kyr, combined with hunter-gatherer demographic data. Findings per abstract: the record supports the view that hominin presence in Arabia was tied to enhanced monsoon precipitation during "Green Arabia" periods, with marked population expansions during prolonged wetter periods. Occupation was, however, not linked exclusively to classic humid periods: brief phases of high-intensity rainfall within some glacials — expressed as transient high dust contents due to more terrestrial moisture and more wind-erodible material — also favoured expansions according to the authors. Interpretation: high dust is not read uniformly as "dry" here — a methodologically relevant point for interpreting dust and terrigenous proxies in northeast African–Arabian archives. Directly connected to the question of how humid phases and dispersal corridors between East Africa and Arabia relate. *Topic 38 · Method 16 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 25 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1038/s41467-026-78983-y

2. Interhemispheric monsoon dynamics over the past 450,000 years · *Nature*, 2026 · **Score 83** A **speleothem $\delta^{18}O$ record from the Amazon Basin** documents South American Summer Monsoon (SASM) variability over 450 kyr. Findings per abstract: monsoons in both hemispheres vary with Milankovitch forcing and internal boundary conditions; SASM and the Asian monsoon have been strikingly out of phase, but occasionally behave synchronously. The authors define a **synchronicity threshold** that is exceeded during ten events, including glacial terminations; comparison with forcing factors points to greenhouse gases, cross-equatorial thermal gradients and Atlantic/Pacific SSTs as probable influences (interpretation, not a causal test). Methodologically close to questions about phase relationships and regime shifts between proxy series; useful for placing African monsoon records in the global monsoon system. *Topic 36 · Method 20 · Venue 15 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 6 (created 15 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1038/s41586-026-11166-3

3. Dual biomarker $\delta^{2}H$ and $\delta^{13}C$ records allow deconvolution of precipitation and evaporation signals in Lake Junin sediments since the last glacial maximum · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 81** At Lake Junín (central Andes) the authors separate the **precipitation signal** (terrestrial nC_{29} alkanes) from the **evaporation signal** (aquatic nC_{23}

alkanes) using two independent isotope systems (δ^2H_wax, $\delta^{13}C$_wax); brGDGTs constrain the temperature–drought relationship. Findings per abstract: the water-balance reconstruction shows high sensitivity of the central Andes to monsoon intensity, driven by both large-scale circulation (P) and local conditions (E); significant variations in evaporative enrichment over ~22 kyr, with reduced P−E balance and local water stress particularly in the middle Holocene. Directly relevant for lake water-balance models: a proxy approach that addresses P and E separately provides exactly the constraints otherwise missing in water-balance calculations for closed lake basins. *Topic 36 · Method 18 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 19 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110341

4. Climate-modulated accumulation and erosion of sediments in the Rodderberg crater basin for the last 439 ka (East Eifel Volcanic Field, Germany) · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 80** A discontinuous **73-m sediment record from the Rodderberg crater** with high-resolution grain-size and geochemical data, dated by radiocarbon, luminescence and tephrochronology, reaching back into the Middle Pleistocene (439 ka). Findings per abstract: laminated, sand- and organic-rich sediments during interglacials, layered silt-rich loess derivatives during glacials; the crater desiccated during MIS 8 and MIS 5, eroding the MIS 9 and MIS 5e interglacials. Sequence according to the authors: deep crater lake (MIS 12–10), desiccation (MIS 8), shallow lake (MIS 7), desiccating wetland (MIS 6), followed by loess and a Holocene soil. An important long record for central European lake archives — and a case study in how erosional gaps can bias the interpretation of long lake cores. *Topic 36 · Method 18 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 22 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1002/jqs.70131

5. Intense rainstorms as drivers of lacustrine turbidity currents: implications for paleoflood records · *Sedimentologika*, 2026 · **Score 79** Process study at the subaqueous Muota delta (Lake Lucerne): hydro-meteorological catchment data, **moored ADCP measurements of turbidity currents** and sediment cores covering ~50 years. Findings per abstract: the largest floods correspond clearly to thick, extensive turbidites, whereas moderate floods leave variable or no deposits. Turbidity-current initiation is governed not by discharge alone but by suspended sediment concentration — and thus by rainfall characteristics and sediment mobilisation. Short high-intensity rainstorms can trigger discharge-decoupled turbidity currents, while some higher but less turbid discharge peaks do not. The authors recommend process-based calibration with monitoring data. Directly relevant for interpreting lacustrine palaeoflood archives: deposit thickness is not a linear discharge proxy. *Topic 40 · Method 16 · Venue 5 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 21 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.57035/journals/sdk.2026.e42.2473

6. Erosional Transfer of Sediment and Organic Carbon Through Time in the Kasaï Basin, Democratic Republic of the Congo · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · **Score 78** Sediment cores from **ten lakes along the rainforest–savanna boundary in the Kasaï Basin**; apparent sediment accumulation rates, TOC and bulk density yield organic-carbon mass accumulation rates. Findings per abstract: most lakes show reduced accumulation during the **Late Holocene Rainforest Crisis** (~3000 yr BP), mirroring peat cores from the Cuvette Centrale; according to the authors the crisis was thus more widespread than previously postulated, not limited to central-western Africa. Carbon deposited over the last ~5000 cal yr BP in two representative records is highly susceptible to remineralisation upon oxygen exposure. Connects to the question of how spatially coherent the end of the African Humid Period was in equatorial Africa. *Topic 34 · Method 15 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 22 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1029/2026pa005609

Relevant (50–74)

7. Humans experienced abrupt environmental changes at White Sands during the Last Glacial Maximum · *Science Advances*, 2026 · **Score 74** Expanded excavations at White Sands National Park: 20 horizons with in-situ human and megafaunal footprints. Radiocarbon dating of conifer pollen plus aquatic seeds refines the chronology to **23.5–21.7 ka**. Findings per abstract: biomarkers, pollen and stratigraphy show a turnover from a perennial lake to a playa and a major aridification episode coincident with Dansgaard–Oeschger event 2 (23.2 ka), which shrank pluvial Lake Otero and allowed people to traverse the former shoreline for nearly two millennia. A human–environment case at a shrinking lake — structurally comparable to questions asked of East African rift lakes. *Topic 32 · Method 15 · Venue 15 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 6 (created 14 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1126/sciadv.aeh0707

8. Environmental dynamics and timing of the late Eemian interglacial to the Weichselian pleniglacial at Lichtenberg, Germany: implications for the Oerel and Glinde interstadials · *Boreas*, 2026 · **Score 72** Multi-proxy record (sedimentology, geochemistry, palynology) from two cores at Lichtenberg (Lower Saxony), next to a Middle Palaeolithic site, with new OSL ages. Findings per abstract: two previously unresolved oscillations (Dangenstorf I/II) with dwarf-birch shrub tundra, correlated with the Oerel and Glinde interstadials; per OSL placed at the **MIS 5a/4** transition and assigned to Greenland Interstadials GI 20 and 19.2 — not MIS 3 as previously assumed. Relevant for chronostratigraphy and correlation of central European archives with North Atlantic variability. *Topic 32 · Method 16 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 19 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1111/bor.70078

9. Ideas for Creating Early Warning Systems in the Climate Sciences · *EGUsphere* (preprint, in discussion), 2026 · **Score 72** Perspective and review: generic early-warning indicators (e.g. critical slowing down) make little use of process understanding; the authors argue for **process-informed early warning systems** whose structure reflects the dynamics of the system in question — drawing on Earth observation (space-for-time approaches), meteorological forcing data, reduced dynamical models and ESM process descriptions. No new data; conceptually relevant for tipping-point analyses of palaeorecords, where the same question of generic vs. system-specific indicators arises. Not yet peer-reviewed. *Topic 30 · Method 22 · Venue 4 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 20 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.5194/egusphere-2026-5606

10. Tipping point forecasting in nonstationary dynamics on function spaces · *PNAS*, 2026 · **Score 72** A recurrent neural operator (RNO) is trained only on **pre-tipping** dynamics; a conformal-prediction framework forecasts tipping points from deviations from physics constraints (conserved quantities, PDEs) with an uncertainty measure. Tested on Lorenz-63, Kuramoto–Sivashinsky, a stratocumulus tipping point and flow-stall transitions. Findings per abstract: even partial or approximate physics constraints suffice for accurate forecasts. Methodologically interesting, but only of limited transferability to proxy series without known equations of motion (assessment). *Topic 30 · Method 18 · Venue 15 · Connectivity 3 · Recency 6 (created 15 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1073/pnas.2600331123

Radar

- **Human and climate-environment interactions in Pyrenean landscapes: a Lateglacial-Holocene multiproxy reconstruction** · *Biogeosciences* · **70** · sedaDNA, pollen and charcoal over 25 kyr: mid-Holocene opening first triggered by Neoglacial cooling, then maintained by pastoralism — synergy rather than either/or, per the authors. DOI: 10.5194/bg-23-7411-2026 · created 23 Oct 2026

- **Coherent regional expressions of Holocene summer temperature on Greenland** · *EGUsphere* (preprint) · **70** 🟡 · Uncertainty-weighted factor analysis of 38 heterogeneous proxy series: two modes (peak 7.2 ka in the north/east; 5.4 ka in the south/southwest); no existing reconstruction reproduces the full spatial structure. Methodologically transferable to heterogeneous proxy networks. DOI: 10.5194/egusphere-2026-5983 · created 22 Oct 2026
- **Climate change restructures extreme-event memory and hydroclimatic regime persistence across Africa** · *Journal of Hydrology* · **68** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · Memory and persistence of hydroclimatic regimes across Africa; link to time-series and persistence analysis, findings with reservations. DOI: 10.1016/j.jhydrol.2026.136641 · created 20 Oct 2026
- **Seasonally divergent early-warning indicators of Amazon hydrological change** · *Scientific Reports* · **67** 🟡 · Variance, lag-1 autocorrelation, skewness, kurtosis and entropy over ~45 years of hydrological series, tested against stationary surrogates; signals shift spatially between seasons. A clean example of surrogate testing of early-warning indicators. DOI: 10.1038/s41598-026-73168-5 · created 16 Oct 2026
- **Early-warning signals of critical transitions in global ecoregions** · *iScience* · **66** 🟡 · 22 years of satellite vegetation data: per abstract about a quarter of ecoregions show consistent signals of emerging structural transitions. DOI: 10.1016/j.isci.2026.117964 · created 20 Oct 2026
- **Ecosystem resilience trajectories, drivers and early-warning signals of degradation across the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau** · *Global and Planetary Change* · **65** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · Resilience trajectories and early-warning signals; findings with reservations. DOI: 10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105781 · created 23 Oct 2026
- **Millennial-Scale Climate States Alter Atlantic Multidecadal Variability Mechanisms in a Climate Model** · *Geophysical Research Letters* · **64** 🟡 · 2000-year pre-industrial simulation: the AMV mechanism depends on the millennial background state (ocean- vs atmosphere-driven) — state-dependent variability, a recurring motif. DOI: 10.1029/2026gl123473 · created 20 Oct 2026
- **Warming since the Last Glacial Maximum amplifies Northern Hemisphere drought expansion driven by the Pacific Decadal Oscillation** · *Communications Earth & Environment* · **62** 🟡 · Reanalysis plus present-day and LGM simulations: PDO regime shifts move subtropical troughs; per abstract, warming since the LGM amplifies the drying effect of negative PDO phases. DOI: 10.1038/s43247-026-04186-4 · created 21 Oct 2026
- **Net Carbon Transfer From Ocean to Land During the Last Deglaciation Synchronous With Sea Level Rise and Lagging Atmospheric CO_2 by Several Millennia** · *Geophysical Research Letters* · **62** 🟡 · Compilation of 902 foraminiferal isotope series: mean ocean $\delta^{13}C$ rises roughly in step with sea level and ~2 kyr after atmospheric CO_2. DOI: 10.1029/2026gl123828 · created 20 Oct 2026
- **Orbital-scale precipitation variations in the western Qaidam Basin during the Late Pliocene** · *Climate of the Past* · **62** 🟡 · Magnetic and grain-size series (~3.6–1.8 Ma): changing orbital control of precipitation in inner Asia. Open access. DOI: 10.5194/cp-22-1913-2026 · created 19 Oct 2026
- **Late Holocene reexpansion of the Laurentide Ice Sheet** · *Science* · **61** 🟡 · Barnes Ice Cap: minimum after ~3.6 ka, re-expansion from ~2 ka, maximum ~1960 CE, then anthropogenically driven retreat. DOI: 10.1126/science.aed3379 · created 22 Oct 2026
- **The Baffin Bay Ice Shelf stabilized three adjacent ice sheets during the last glacial period** · *Nature Geoscience* · **61** 🟡 · Geomorphic evidence for a basin-spanning ice shelf

(~150,000 km²) at the LGM; the authors link its collapse to rapid ice retreat. DOI: 10.1038/s41561-026-02126-7 · created 21 Oct 2026

- **Ocean carbon sequestration during glacial climates due to combined Antarctic sea ice expansion and ocean circulation change** · *Science Advances* · **61** 🟡 · Model study: only the combination of sea-ice expansion and circulation change stores carbon in the abyss. DOI: 10.1126/sciadv.ady6777 · created 21 Oct 2026
- **Millennial-scale climate instability and dust accumulation dynamics during the Last Glacial Period revealed by loess sequences from the northeastern Tibetan Plateau** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology* · **60** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · Millennial variability in loess sequences. DOI: 10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114293 · created 24 Oct 2026
- **From natural to anthropogenic fire in NW China: A two-millennium fire history of Bosten Lake** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **60** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · Two-millennium fire history from a large arid lake. DOI: 10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110344 · created 20 Oct 2026
- **The proteome of Middle Pleistocene Xujiayao and common Denisovan morphology** · *Nature* · **58** 🟡 · Palaeoproteomics assigns Xujiayao (~199–138 ka) to the Denisovan lineage; shared traits with other East Asian archaic Homo. DOI: 10.1038/s41586-026-11132-z · created 21 Oct 2026
- **Millennial-Scale Deoxygenation in the Southern California Oxygen Minimum Zone Over the Last Glacial Cycle** · *Geophysical Research Letters* · **58** 🟡 · Redox-sensitive trace metals (ODP 1017E, ~140 kyr): millennial deoxygenation events during glacial inception. DOI: 10.1029/2026gl126297 · created 12 Oct 2026
- **Past moisture and vegetation conditions at Lake Aura, Norway using n-alkanes and pollen** · *The Holocene* · **57** 🟡 · Three peat cores: pollen and n-alkanes largely converge but diverge at times — different signal sources. DOI: 10.1177/09596836261487383 · created 12 Oct 2026
- **New perspectives on the Howiesons Poort from the site of Kathu Pan 6, South Africa** · *Quaternary International* · **53** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · Howiesons Poort in the South African interior. DOI: 10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110485 · created 22 Oct 2026
- **Vegetation and climate dynamics in the northwestern Altai (MIS 9–MIS 2): Implications for archaic hominin ecology** · *Review of Palaeobotany and Palynology* · **53** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based*. DOI: 10.1016/j.revpalbo.2026.105755 · created 19 Oct 2026
- **Technological organization and residential behavior among early Homo sapiens in North Africa: The Aterian occupation of Bizmoune Cave, Morocco** · *Journal of Human Evolution* · **51** 🟡 · First use-wear analysis of Aterian lithics (layer 4c, 142–110 ka). DOI: 10.1016/j.jhevol.2026.103902 · created 13 Oct 2026
- **A high-resolution Termination II trace gas record and chronology for a continuous ice core from the Allan Hills Blue Ice Area, Antarctica** · *EGUsphere* (preprint) · **51** 🟡 · CO_2, CH_4, N_2O across T-II (~149–116 ka), gas-phase chronology via correlation with EDC. DOI: 10.5194/egusphere-2026-5793 · created 13 Oct 2026
- **Did desertification in China's dunefields intensify or abate during the early little ice age?** · *Catena* · **49** 🟢 · ⚠ *title-based*. DOI: 10.1016/j.catena.2026.110671 · created 15 Oct 2026

Not listed or only noted: The *Nature* news item "Cave stalagmites document global patterns in monsoon rainfall over the past 450,000 years" comments on entry 2 and is not a primary article. A handbook chapter "The African Humid Periods: From Green Sahara dynamics to Earth-system sensitivity" (*Reference Module in Earth Systems and Environmental Sciences*, DOI 10.1016/

b978-0-443-15748-6.00091-5) is noted as an overview but not scored. Not included: a Preprints.org manuscript on *Homo naledi* (not peer-reviewed, no geoscience focus in the narrow sense) and numerous off-topic topic-query hits ("early warning", "Turkana" in a social-science context). Already listed in Week 43 and therefore excluded are, among others, the *Etheria* study (EGQSJ) and the Kikai-Akahoya paper (*Science Advances*).

Part B — Funding & calls

ICDP — AGU 2026 travel grants for early-career researchers — deadline 8 Nov 2026. Several grants of US$300 each for presenting ICDP-related work at the AGU Fall Meeting (CV + accepted abstract). Source: PAGES newsletter October 2026.

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opens **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**, Research and Innovation Action, around €14 million for about two projects (as of previous issue, unchanged). Source: topic page.

ERC Consolidator Grant 2027 — deadline 12 Jan 2027. Open since 24 Sep 2026; eligibility per ERC Work Programme 2027 (generally 7–12 years after the PhD). Source: ERC — Consolidator Grant.

ERC 2027 — further dates. Proof of Concept opens 12 Nov 2026 (first cut-off 10 Mar 2027), **Synergy Grant** 17 Feb – 11 May 2027, **Advanced Grant** 27 May – 26 Aug 2027 (per a summary of Work Programme 2027; check the ERC site before planning). Source: Hezelburcht — ERC Work Programme 2027.

ICDP — 2027 proposal cycle. Recurring deadline **15 January** for pre-, workshop, full and fast-track proposals; ICDP recommends submitting pre-proposals at least two months earlier and fast-track letters of intent "by early November at the latest". The 2027 date has not been formally confirmed. Source: ICDP — Proposal preparation.

DFG — Priority Programme ICDP (SPP 1006). The 2026 round closed on 23 Sep 2026; the next round is usually announced in summer (not verified). Funds work on ICDP drilling data and samples and the preparation of drilling projects. Source: DFG — Information for Researchers No. 42/2026.

DFG — Open-access publication funding. Institutional proposals for the first time by **4 May 2027** (as of previous issue). Source: DFG — Information for Researchers No. 68.

Part C — Science policy (DE/EU)

WissZeitVG — research committee to decide on a public hearing. According to the second supplementary agenda, the Bundestag research committee was scheduled on **14 Oct 2026** to decide on a public hearing on the government bill to "modernise fixed-term contract law in academia" (BT-Drs. 21/8281), the Greens' motion "Good work on campus" (21/6345) and the Left's motion to abolish the special fixed-term regime (21/8384). No hearing date could be found publicly at the time of writing. Key points of the bill as a reminder: minimum durations for first contracts (three years before, two years after the PhD), family-related extensions also for third-party-funded contracts, a two-year care extension, evaluation in 2032; the federal government rejects the Bundesrat's demand that contracts shorter than the minimum be deemed to run for

the minimum duration. Assessment: the hearing opens the phase in which changes to the bill become realistic — for third-party-funded postdoc positions the minimum duration remains the key issue. Sources: Research committee agenda, 2nd supplement (PDF) · Bundestag — text archive week 41.

Federal budget 2027 — final committee session on 12 Nov, final vote on 27 Nov. In recent sitting weeks the budget committee approved further individual budgets without numerical changes; changes are still possible in the **final committee session (Bereinigungssitzung, 12 Nov 2026)**. Second reading 24–27 Nov, third reading with final vote on **27 Nov 2026**. Status of the government draft: BMFTR core budget about €22 billion, nominally about +0.7% (as of previous issue). Assessment: whether project funding and DFG allocations shift is decided in the final committee session. Sources: Bundestag — budget 2027 timeline · hib 839/2026 (16 Oct 2026) · Forschung & Lehre — Only a small increase for the BMFTR core budget.

EU — Parliament adopts position on the 2027 EU budget; MFF 2028–2034 still open. On **21 Oct 2026** the European Parliament adopted its position on the 2027 annual budget: according to the Brussels Times about €194 billion in commitments, €1.17 billion above the Commission draft, including **+€63 million for Horizon Europe**; negotiations with the Council start in early November, a conciliation committee may meet until mid-November. It is the last annual budget of the current MFF. In parallel, the **MFF 2028–2034** — and with it the budget of FP10 and the ERC from 2028 — remains open after the 15–16 Oct summit (see Week 43). Sources: Brussels Times (21 Oct 2026) · Lovguiden — EU budget 2027 timeline · European Council — conclusions 15–16 Oct 2026.

Part D — Community & dates

- **EGU General Assembly 2027** — **4–9 Apr 2027**, Vienna; abstract submission opens on **28 Oct 2026** according to the PAGES newsletter (deadline usually mid-January, not verified). Source: PAGES newsletter October 2026.
- **PAGES** — **Data Science Officer** position at the International Project Office in Bern; review of applications from **2 Nov 2026** (as of previous issue). Source: PAGES — news.
- **ICDP AGU 2026 travel grants** — deadline **8 Nov 2026**.
- **ERC Proof of Concept** — opens **12 Nov 2026**.
- **German federal budget 2027** — final committee session **12 Nov**, final vote **27 Nov 2026**.
- **Horizon CL5 palaeoclimate call** — opens **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**.
- **AGU Fall Meeting 2026** — **7–11 Dec 2026**, San Francisco. Source: AGU.
- **ERC Consolidator Grant 2027** — deadline **12 Jan 2027**.
- **ICDP** — proposal deadline expected **15 Jan 2027**.
- **PAGES dates 2027** — workshop "Coastal Hypoxia through the Common Era" **27–29 Apr 2027** (Qingdao); PALSEA-Next **24–26 Jun 2027** (Dartmouth College); **PMIP conference 30 Aug – 3 Sep 2027** (Rio de Janeiro). Source: PAGES newsletter October 2026.

Methods & sources

Paper screening follows the fixed set of criteria (topical fit, methodological fit, impact/venue, connectivity, recency) and excludes DOIs already listed in a previous issue. Funding opportunities, science policy and dates are based on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

How this issue was produced. Direct network access from the computing environment was blocked. The **Crossref REST API** (ISSN queries of 40+ journals, including QSR, Climate of the Past, Quat. Sci. Adv., GPC, EPSL, Boreas, JQS, Quat. Res., P³, Nature, Science, PNAS, Nature Commun., Nature Geosci., Sci. Adv., Commun. Earth Environ., GRL, G-cubed, Paleoceanogr. Paleoclimatol., Quat. Int., The Holocene, J. African Earth Sci., Geomorphology, J. Human Evol., J. Hydrol.; the Copernicus prefix including EGUsphere; topic queries; filter `from-created-date: 2026-10-12`) and **OpenAlex** (abstracts by DOI, reconstructed from the `abstract_inverted_index`) were queried via the integrated browser interface (`fetch()`); two abstracts (entries 1 and 2) were taken from the publisher page (Nature Portfolio). ScienceDirect landing pages were not reachable.

What this means for coverage. Where neither OpenAlex nor Crossref holds an abstract, the entry is marked ⚠ *title-based*;
no results beyond the title were invented. Dates given are Crossref `created` dates (registration), which may differ from the online publication date by a few days. Topic queries return a lot of off-topic noise; pre-selection was by keywords and then manual, so individual relevant papers outside the core journals may be missing.

GeoNews is an automatically compiled digest published by Dr. Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature overview with no affiliation to the publishers or funding bodies mentioned and does not constitute a recommendation or advice. Details may contain errors; when in doubt, the linked original source prevails. Corrections and comments are welcome.